Which Marketing Role Fits You?

A self-assessment for starting a marketing career in Japan

Name

Date

How to fill in this PDF
Tap a circle to choose an answer, and tap a box to type. Save the file when you finish so your answers are kept. This works in the Files app on iPhone, Adobe Acrobat Reader, and most PDF apps.

This form helps you choose between four beginner-friendly marketing jobs. There are no right or wrong answers. Answer honestly, not with what sounds impressive.

Part 1 takes about 20 minutes. Part 2 is four short tasks of 20 minutes each, and you can spread them over several days.

The four roles

- **Social media SNS運用**
  Plan, create and post content for a company's Instagram, TikTok, X or LINE, and read how it performed.
- **Ad operations 広告運用**
  Set up and adjust paid ads on Google, Yahoo!, LINE and Meta so each yen brings in more customers.
- **SEO & content SEO・コンテンツ**
  Write articles and pages that people find through search, and improve them over time.
- **Analytics & CRM アクセス解析・CRM**
  Track what visitors and customers do, find problems in the numbers, and report them clearly.

Part 1: Questions

Choose the one answer closest to you. If two feel equal, pick the one you'd choose on a tired day.

01 On a free afternoon, which sounds most appealing?

- A Writing a long post about something you know well
- B Making a set of good-looking posts for a friend's shop
- C Organizing a messy spreadsheet until it makes sense
- D Trying a few versions of something to see which one wins

02 When you see an ad or post that really works, what do you notice first?

- A How many clicks or sales it probably brought in
- B The wording and the story
- C The visual style and the mood
- D How they knew to show it to someone like you

03 **Something you made performed badly. What's your first reaction?**

- **A** Look at the data to find exactly where it went wrong
- **B** Change one thing at a time and test again
- **C** Rewrite it so it's clearer and more useful
- **D** Redesign it so it catches attention faster

04 **How quickly do you like to see results from your work?**

- **A** Within hours
- **B** Within a day or two
- **C** Over weeks or months. I'm patient
- **D** Speed doesn't matter if I'm finding interesting patterns

05 **Imagine you're responsible for a client's ¥1,000,000 monthly ad budget. How do you feel?**

- **A** Excited. I'd want to make every yen count
- **B** Fine if someone else decides; I'd rather check the numbers
- **C** Nervous. I'd rather make the posts people see
- **D** I'd rather build something that grows without spending money

06 **Which task would you volunteer for?**

- **A** Writing a weekly report that explains results to a client
- **B** Replying to customer comments and messages
- **C** Researching what questions people type into Google
- **D** Setting up a tracking sheet so the whole team sees the same numbers

07 **Which daily rhythm suits you best?**

- **A** Many small tasks for several clients every day
- **B** A posting schedule that follows the latest trends
- **C** Long, focused blocks on one project
- **D** Careful, detailed work where accuracy matters most

08 Which tool would you most like to master?

- A Canva or CapCut
- B Google Ads or Meta Ads Manager
- C Google Analytics or Excel
- D WordPress or Google Search Console

09 In past jobs or school, what were you praised for?

- A Persuading people or hitting sales targets
- B Clear writing or explaining things well
- C Creativity, design sense, or knowing what's trending
- D Being accurate, organized and reliable with details

10 Which result would make you proudest?

- A “Your article is the top Google result for this topic.”
- B “Our cost per new customer fell 30% because of you.”
- C “Your post went viral and our followers doubled.”
- D “Your report showed us a problem nobody else saw.”

11 What's your ideal working style?

- A Fully remote with flexible hours, maybe freelance
- B In an office with a team, fast-paced
- C Remote or hybrid, mixing creative work with talking to customers
- D Quiet and structured, with clear processes

12 How do you use social media yourself?

- A I post often and follow trends closely
- B I mostly read and search for information
- C I notice the ads and wonder how much they cost
- D I rarely use it; I'd rather work with data

Part 2: Try the work

Trying real work tells you more than answering questions about yourself. Spend about 20 minutes on each task. Stop when the time is up, even if you're not finished. Quality doesn't matter here. What matters is how it felt.

All four tasks use the same imaginary business: Café Hinata, a small neighborhood café that also sells coffee beans online.

Social media Task 1

Instagram posts

Café Hinata is launching a seasonal drink, a chestnut latte. Write three Instagram captions for it, each with hashtags. For each one, describe in one sentence what the photo or video should show.

Your work

Optional. Write here or on paper, whichever is easier.

Rate it right after you finish

How much did you enjoy it?

1 2 3 4 5

1 = not at all 5 = very

How easy did it feel?

1 2 3 4 5

1 = not at all 5 = very

Did you want to keep going after 20 minutes?

Yes No

Ad operations Task 2

Budget and headlines

Here is last month's online shop data:

Channel	Visitors	Purchases
Instagram	4,000	20
Google search	1,500	45
LINE	800	32
Email newsletter	300	3

1. Café Hinata has ¥30,000 extra for ads next month. How would you split it across these channels? Explain why in three sentences.
2. Write three Google search ad headlines for the coffee beans, each 15 Japanese characters or fewer.

Your work

Optional. Write here or on paper, whichever is easier.

Rate it right after you finish

How much did you enjoy it?

1	2	3	4	5

1 = not at all 5 = very

How easy did it feel?

1	2	3	4	5

1 = not at all 5 = very

Did you want to keep going after 20 minutes?

Yes No

SEO & content Task 3

Article outline

Plan a blog article for Café Hinata's website titled roughly "How to choose your first coffee grinder." Write the title, five section headings, and one sentence on what each section says. Think about what a beginner would actually type into Google.

Your work

Optional. Write here or on paper, whichever is easier.

Rate it right after you finish

How much did you enjoy it?

1 2 3 4 5

1 = not at all 5 = very

How easy did it feel?

1 2 3 4 5

1 = not at all 5 = very

Did you want to keep going after 20 minutes?

Yes No

Analytics & CRM Task 4

Find the problem

Here are eight weeks of online shop data:

Week	Visitors	Purchases
1	2,100	42
2	2,200	44
3	2,050	41
4	2,150	43
5	2,200	18
6	2,100	20
7	2,250	45
8	2,150	43

1. What changed, and when?
2. List three possible causes.
3. What would you check first, and why?

Your work

Optional. Write here or on paper, whichever is easier.

Rate it right after you finish

How much did you enjoy it?

1	2	3	4	5

1 = not at all 5 = very

How easy did it feel?

1	2	3	4	5

1 = not at all 5 = very

Did you want to keep going after 20 minutes?

Yes No

Part 3: Score your results

Finish Parts 1 and 2 before you look at the scoring key in Part 3.

Use the key to turn each of your Part 1 answers into a role, then add your Part 2 ratings. The role with the highest total is your best starting point.

Scoring key for Part 1

Q	A	B	C	D
1	Content	SNS	Analytics	Ads
2	Ads	Content	SNS	Analytics
3	Analytics	Ads	Content	SNS
4	Ads	SNS	Content	Analytics
5	Ads	Analytics	SNS	Content
6	Ads	SNS	Content	Analytics
7	Ads	SNS	Content	Analytics
8	SNS	Ads	Analytics	Content
9	Ads	Content	SNS	Analytics
10	Content	Ads	SNS	Analytics
11	Content	Ads	SNS	Analytics
12	SNS	Content	Ads	Analytics

My tally

1. Part 1: count how many of your answers landed on each role. The four counts add up to 12.
2. Part 2: add that role's task enjoyment score (1–5).
3. Bonus: add 3 more if you wanted to keep going on that task.

Role	Part 1	Enjoy	Bonus	Total
SNS				
Ads				
Content				
Analytics				

If two roles tie, choose the one whose task felt easier in Part 2.

My top role

Part 4: What your result means

Your highest total shows where to start, not where you must stay. Many marketers move between these roles over their careers.

Social media SNS運用

Plan, create and post content for a company's Instagram, TikTok, X or LINE, and read how it performed.

You probably enjoy

Trends, visuals, writing short and catchy, talking with customers.

Your first step

Take the free LINEヤフー Marketing Skill Badge (LINE official account, Basic) and the Meta Blueprint beginner course. Start a practice Instagram account for an imaginary shop.

Ad operations 広告運用

Set up and adjust paid ads on Google, Yahoo!, LINE and Meta so each yen brings in more customers.

You probably enjoy

Fast results, testing, numbers tied to money, explaining results to others.

Your first step

Take the free Google Ads Search certification on Google Skillshop. Look for agency jobs marked 未経験OK (no experience needed).

SEO & content SEO・コンテンツ

Write articles and pages that people find through search, and improve them over time.

You probably enjoy

Writing, research, patient work that builds over months.

Your first step

Take the free Google Analytics certification, then write two sample articles on a free blog.

Analytics & CRM アクセス解析・CRM

Track what visitors and customers do, find problems in the numbers, and report them clearly.

You probably enjoy

Patterns, accuracy, spreadsheets, finding what others miss.

Your first step

Take the free Google Analytics certification. Consider ウェブ解析士 (Web Analyst) or 統計検定 Grade 3 next.

If two roles are close

That's common, and some pairs are especially in demand:

- Social media + Ad operations → social media ads (SNS広告運用). This is the most common beginner job.
- SEO & content + Analytics → SEO marketer, who improves pages using search data.
- Ad operations + Analytics → performance marketer, focused on cost per customer.
- Social media + SEO & content → content marketer for a brand's own channels.

Check your Part 2 work

Read these only after you have rated the tasks.

Task 2: Instagram brings the most visitors but only about 0.5% buy. LINE (4%) and Google search (3%) turn visitors into buyers far better. A strong answer moves most of the money toward those two, or explains how to fix Instagram first.

Task 4: In weeks 5 and 6, purchases fell by more than half while visitors stayed the same. People still arrived but stopped buying. Good causes to check include a broken checkout or payment page, items out of stock, or a price change. Checking the checkout page first is a strong answer, because it is quick to test and loses sales every day it is broken.

Part 5: Reflect and talk it over

Write short answers. Talking them through with someone you trust helps you decide your next step. Save this file when you finish.

1. Did your result surprise you? Why or why not?

2. Which task would you happily do again tomorrow, and which would you avoid?

3. Was anything harder than you expected? What would help you get better at it?

4. Is there anything in your life right now (time, money, location, family) that makes one role easier or harder to start?

5. What is one small step you can finish in the next two weeks?

My notes